



Internal Ops · Field guide

# Give your projects a memory.

Vault-based context management, what **adjutant** does with it, and how to set up the CLI — the suitcase included.

|            |                          |                     |                                          |  |
|------------|--------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------|--|
| 8 min read | needs <b>Claude Code</b> | and <b>Obsidian</b> | on <b>macOS, Windows</b> or <b>Linux</b> |  |
|------------|--------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------|--|

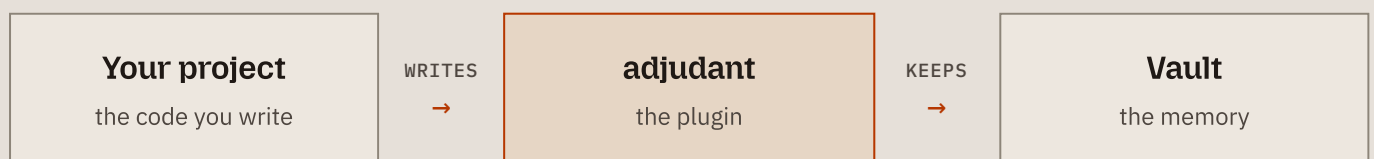
## A vault is your project's memory.

Work spans days. The *why* behind a decision, what you tried last week, where you left off — it lives in your head or scrolls out of a chat, then it's gone. A **vault** holds it instead: an **Obsidian vault** — a folder of markdown files, in a consistent shape, that you read and navigate in [Obsidian](#) (free), where the notes, the links between them, and the board come to life.

### What lives in it

|                                                      |                                                   |                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sessions</b><br>What happened each day you worked | <b>Decisions</b><br>The choices you made, and why | <b>Handoff</b><br>Where things stand, for next time |
| <b>Board</b><br>Your tasks, on a kanban              |                                                   |                                                     |

### How it fits together



And it reads back when you ask **sitrep** or **check**.

What a connected project looks like

```
Claude Vault/  
└ projects/  
  └ my-app/  
    ├── brief.md           the project's purpose  
    ├── sessions/         one note per working day  
    ├── decisions/         why you chose things  
    ├── tasks/             → becomes the board  
    ├── board/             the kanban, saved to disk  
    └ _handoff.md          where things stand
```

# adjutant keeps it current. You just work.

It's a Claude Code plugin that writes to the vault for you. Most of it is invisible — some things happen on their own, and a handful of commands are there when you want them.

|                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Happens on its own</b><br>A session note each day · the handoff kept current · the board reseeded from tasks · every write checked against a shape | <b>You run it</b><br><b>connect</b> once per project · <b>sitrep</b> when you're back · <b>check</b> for a look · <b>tidy</b> to clean up |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

The seven verbs

|                                                                   |                                             |                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>connect</b> Link a project to its vault                        | <b>sync</b> Push current state to the vault | <b>check</b> Health report <span>READ ONLY</span>   |
| <b>sitrep</b> “Where was I?” after a break <span>READ ONLY</span> | <b>tidy</b> Safe cleanup, previews first    | <b>dream</b> Advisory review <span>READ ONLY</span> |
| <b>board</b> Drag-and-drop kanban                                 |                                             |                                                     |

**On dream, and on cost**  
**dream** reads your notes and hands you a report — what's stale, what contradicts, what's orphaned — then **stops**. It changes nothing on its own; you decide. And the whole plugin is built to be light: heavy reads estimate their cost and ask first.

# Set it up.

First, install the two free apps this needs: **Claude Code** and **Obsidian** — on a Mac, `brew install --cask obsidian`, or download from obsidian.md.

### On Windows or Linux

The three steps below are the same on every system. On **Windows**, run Claude Code inside **WSL** (Windows Subsystem for Linux). WSL gives you the Unix shell the plugin expects; install it once with `wsl --install` in PowerShell, then open **Ubuntu** and work there. Your vault can sit in **OneDrive** — adjudant finds it on its own, from Windows or from WSL. On **Linux** it all works as-is. For the apps, use your platform's tools: `winget install Obsidian.Obsidian` on Windows, your package manager on Linux.

Each box below has a **Copy** button. Copy it, then paste it where the label says — your Terminal app, or the Claude Code chat. You don't type the box itself.

## 1 Get access

The repo is private, so GitHub has to let Claude Code in. You do this once per computer.

**In your Terminal app** signs you in to GitHub

```
gh auth login
```

## 2 Install the plugin

Paste these into the Claude Code chat, one at a time.

**In Claude Code** tells it where to find the tool

```
/plugin marketplace add TomVDH/furtive-follies
```

**In Claude Code** installs adjudant

```
/plugin install adjudant
```

## 3 Connect your project

Do this once inside each project. It shows where a vault can live, recommends a spot, and makes it for you.

**In Claude Code** sets up the vault

```
/adjudant connect
```

## 4 Open it in Obsidian

connect makes the vault folder for you. In Obsidian, choose **Open folder as vault** and pick that folder — now you can read your notes, follow the links between them, and see the board.

### Where your vault should live

#### Cloud-sync folder — recommended

iCloud, OneDrive, Google Drive, Dropbox. Your notes follow you across computers.

#### Local folder

~/Documents. Fine if you only ever use one computer.

✓ **That's it.** The record-keeping runs from here. Come back and ask /adjutant sitrep after a break.

## The terminal, in ten commands.

The terminal is a text way to tell your computer what to do. You point it at a folder, then run a command. These ten cover almost everything a beginner needs. Type one, press Enter.

|              |                                                    |                         |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>pwd</b>   | Show the folder you're in right now                | <b>pwd</b>              |
| <b>ls</b>    | List what's in this folder                         | <b>ls</b>               |
| <b>cd</b>    | Go into a folder — or <b>cd ..</b> to go up one    | <b>cd projects</b>      |
| <b>mkdir</b> | Make a new folder                                  | <b>mkdir notes</b>      |
| <b>cp</b>    | Copy a file                                        | <b>cp a.md b.md</b>     |
| <b>mv</b>    | Move a file, or rename it                          | <b>mv old.md new.md</b> |
| <b>rm</b>    | Delete a file. No undo — see <b>trash</b> below    | <b>rm draft.md</b>      |
| <b>cat</b>   | Print a file to the screen                         | <b>cat notes.md</b>     |
| <b>less</b>  | Read a long file a page at a time — <b>q</b> quits | <b>less big.log</b>     |
| <b>clear</b> | Wipe the screen clean                              | <b>clear</b>            |

Not sure what a command does? Run **tlldr <command>** for a plain, example-first reminder (it comes with the suitcase, below).

## The suitcase: a

# friendlier terminal.

The bundle ships a small kit of command-line tools — the **suitcase**. It makes the terminal nicer without changing how anything works, and it's optional. The check run below changes nothing; the second one installs. Anything you already have is skipped.

In your Terminal app · inside the downloaded folder

a dry run — shows what it would do

```
bash onboarding/onboard.sh --check
```

In your Terminal app

installs the tools for real

```
bash onboarding/onboard.sh
```

## What each tool does

**ALTERS** means the same command now gives nicer output. **ADDS** means a new command that sits beside your old ones. **ls**, **cd**, **rm**, **grep** and **find** stay exactly as they were — nothing you already know stops working.

|                               |                                                                                   |                                                             |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>z</b> <b>ADDS</b>          | Jump to a folder by name, from anywhere                                           | <code>cd ../../work/app</code> → <code>z app</code>         |
| <b>ll</b> <b>ADDS</b>         | A rich listing: sizes, dates, git state ( <code>l</code> and <code>lt</code> too) | <code>ls -lah</code> → <code>ll</code>                      |
| <b>cat</b> <b>ALTERS</b>      | Same command, now with color and line numbers. Stays plain when piped             | <code>cat app.py</code> → <code>cat app.py</code>           |
| <b>rg</b> <b>ADDS</b>         | Search inside files, fast                                                         | <code>grep -rn TODO .</code> → <code>rg TODO</code>         |
| <b>fd</b> <b>ADDS</b>         | Find files by name                                                                | <code>find . -name "*.md"</code> → <code>fd .md</code>      |
| <b>git diff</b> <b>ALTERS</b> | Same command, now a clear colored side-by-side                                    | a wall of +/- lines → a readable diff                       |
| <b>trash</b> <b>ADDS</b>      | Delete to the Trash, not forever. <code>rm</code> is left alone                   | <code>rm note.md</code> (gone) → <code>trash note.md</code> |
| <b>glow</b> <b>ADDS</b>       | Read a markdown file, nicely rendered                                             | <code>cat notes.md</code> → <code>glow notes.md</code>      |
| <b>tldr</b> <b>ADDS</b>       | Plain, example-first help for any command                                         | <code>man tar</code> → <code>tldr tar</code>                |

**sl** and **cbonsai** earn their place by adding nothing useful — a steam train and a bonsai tree, for when the terminal needs a smile.

## Recommended terminal setup

**REQUIRED**

**Zsh · [zsh.org](#)**

The shell the shortcuts assume. It's the macOS default; on Windows (WSL) or Linux, install it first, then switch with the command shown.

```
chsh -s $(which zsh)
```

RECOMMENDED

iTerm2 · [item2.com](#)

A nicer terminal than the built-in one. Repo:  
[gnachman/iTerm2](#)

```
brew install --cask iterm2
```

RECOMMENDED

Powerlevel10k · [romkatv/powerlevel10k](#)

A fast, informative prompt. Install it, add it to `~/.zshrc`,  
then run `p10k configure`. [Install guide →](#)

```
brew install powerlevel10k
```

## Optional: a live statusline

The bundle also ships a small statusline. It shows your git branch, the vault this project is linked to, and how full the context window is — a quiet reminder to keep sessions short. Turn it on with one line in `~/.claude/settings.json`, using the real path to the script.

In `~/.claude/settings.json` turns the statusline on

```
"statusLine": { "type": "command", "command": "bash ~/furtive-follies/onboard
```

Point the path at wherever you put the folder. It uses `jq` or `python3` to read the status; with neither, it still shows the git part.

Not on a Mac? On **Windows**, do this inside **WSL**; on **Linux**, in your normal shell. Install the tools with your package manager (`apt`, `dnf`, `pacman`), then `source onboarding/casual-qol.zsh`. Every shortcut is guarded, so anything you're missing just skips.

## If something looks off.

### Vault not found

Ask `/adjutant connect` again  
— it re-links the project.

### A write got blocked

The message names the field to  
fix. Adjust it, write again.

### No board yet

It's born on your first task note.  
No tasks, no board.